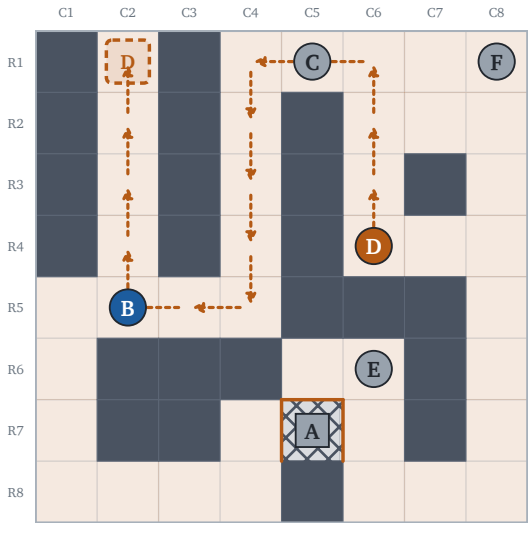
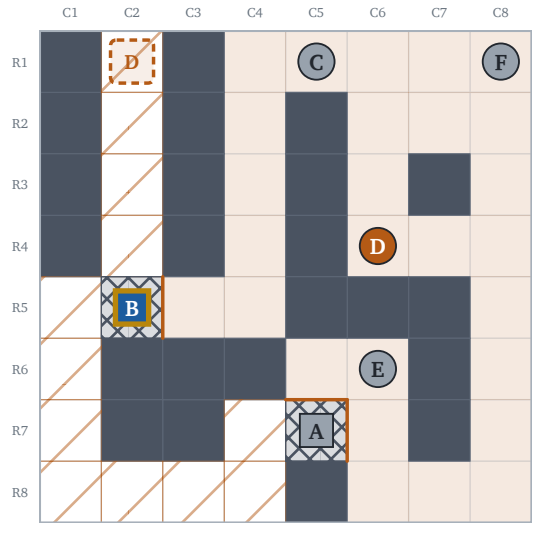
## The seal behind half of every cycle loss

six players, S3 board 14, DeepSeek, freeform — one board, one turn apart, and nothing moves in between

**(a)** move 54: B stands on R5C2




**(b)** move 54: B declares done




object, still able to move

owner declared done: object frozen (square), cell walled

the cut object's target

where the cut object can still move

cells it loses to this declaration

a route that still exists

D must reach R1C2, the dead end of the corridor, and every route to it passes R5C2, the corridor's only entrance.

B's own target is that entrance. Standing there costs nothing — an object can be asked to step aside, and B had offered to.

The declaration is what turns the cell into a wall. The hatched cells in (b) are what D loses by it, for the next 43 moves.

54 of the 101 recorded cuts have exactly this shape.

*“B moves right to goal R5C2. D: I know you need R5C2 to reach R1C2; I'll step left to R5C1 when you reach R5C3, so signal me.”*

B, four moves before declaring done, and the eighth message in a row promising to wait.